5.2 Animal products used as clothing

Animal hair has a great demand. The hair from goat and sheep is used for manufacturing woollen clothes, shawls and blankets, mufflers and socks. Similarly horse hair is used as bristles in small painting brushes. Even fur of animals including the skin is used to make warm and modern style clothes.

Animal Fibres

Some fabric fibres such as cotton, jute, silk are called natural fibres. Cotton and jute are examples of plant fibres. Wool and silk fibres are examples of animal fibres. Wool is obtained from the fleece of sheep or goat. It is also obtained from the hair of rabbit, yak and camel. Silk fibre is obtained from the cocoon of silkworm.

Wool

What type of clothes are being used by people of snow capped region?

Why such kind of clothing is preferred by them?



Wool is the fibre derived from the fur of animals of the Caprinae family principally sheep. The hair of other mammals like goat, yak, alpaca and rabbit may also be called wool. Mostly, wool is produced from the outer coat of sheep. The processing of wool involves five major steps. They are as follows Shearing, Grading (or) Sorting, Washing (or) Scouting, Carding and Spinning.



Sheep



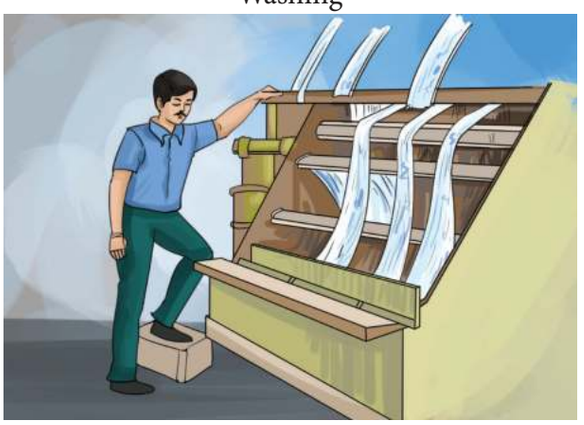
Shearing



Washing



Carding



Spinning

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